

General Science





About the Course

This is the second of a two-year Physical Science course (i.e., introductory physics and chemistry). The fullness of the course includes topics in earth science, history, politics, and more. The completion of this course provides a gentle yet robust transition into the high school disciplines. The lab component is required for this course. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 8

About Science: Grade 8

In level 8, learners study science in its historical, political, and cultural context, and with a growing understanding that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectation increase from previous levels.

Science: Grade 8

The Big Picture:

To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. In Form 1, students became acquainted with this area of knowledge, science. Form 2 students extended their scope and began to encounter science as an active part of society. Form 3 students extend their relationship with science in a new direction (time) and consider science as a process by which man seeks Truth within Creation. They begin to situate science in its historical, political, and cultural context with all of the complexities of man's own story. In this way, students are prepared to think about science with a complete and holistic perspective.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Citizenship Grades 4+).



Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 8

In level 8, learners study science in its historical, political, and cultural context with a growing understanding that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectations increase from previous levels.

General Science: Grade 8

For eighth-grade students or possibly hungry seventh graders or ninth graders taking their time. If combining grades is desirable: the combined grades may begin at the appropriate level and move forward together, or teachers can adapt the reading level and laboratory content to meet their needs.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	General Science: Grade 8 3 times/week 30 min	The Story of Science: Einstein Adds a New Dimension The Story of Science: Newton At the Center

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 8				
Natural History: Grade 8	General Science: Grade 8 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	General Science: Grade 8	General Science: Grade 8 Nature Notebook: Grade 8	Labs: Grade 8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 8

- ☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
- ☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:

- ☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings, except where the suggestion is to collect some Thing for a lesson.
- ☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 8

Encourage students to choose their own special topic and to notice its ecological relationships. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too!

- ☐ Learn a few of your local species or varieties in connection with special topics.

General Science: Grade 8

- ☐ Term 1: A science museum with motion exhibits
- ☐ Term 2: A science museum with chemistry exhibits
- ☐ Term 3: A planetarium or local astronomy club event

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Science: Grade 8

- ☐ Gather household items, typically easy for students to scavenge or teachers to obtain locally:
 - 5 Starburst candies or similarly-shaped manufactured item
 - sturdy wooden board at least 2-3" wide and 3.5' long to construct marble ramp

- anything to create rails for the ramp, more scrap wood, old pool noodles, etc.
- whatever is needed to attach the rails: bar clamps, hammer and nails, glue, etc.
- books or wood blocks to adjust height
- 3 smaller blocks to act as stops
- 1-6 eggs (Term 1)
- water
- large sheet pan or flat location outside
- 2 plastic cups, 1 smaller and 1 larger
- various objects to test for sliding on ramp, such as small objects made of wood, plastic, metal, etc
- various Lego-type blocks that can be used to build a small box, roughly 1-2" dimensions
- a larger bouncy ball, such as a basketball
- a location to bounce balls
- 1/2 c small solid fill material, such as cat food or rice
- 2 locations at 2 different temperatures, such as a sunny window and a chilly basement
- plastic wrap
- wire cutters, such as those on many pliers
- hammer
- at least 2 different light sources, including bright sunlight and at least 1 type of artificial light
- microwave
- microwave-safe casserole dish, at least 9"
- marshmallows to cover the bottom of the dish, Peeps or jumbo work best
- stopwatch, such as found on most electronic devices
- calculator, such as found on most electronic devices
- printables
- computer
- optional: hot glue gun
- optional: long forceps
- optional: matches
- optional: glass jar that is taller than a tea light candle
- optional: hard boiled egg (Term 2)

Reminders

General Science: Grade 8

☐ Note that Lab in week 6 of Term 1 calls for fresh eggs and Lab in week 2 of Term 2 includes an optional activity that uses a hard-boiled egg. Make a note on your calendar if you will need to purchase these closer to the appropriate dates. Refer to the lab book for more details.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Science: Grade 8



The Story of Science: Einstein Adds a New Dimension



The Story of Science: Newton At the Center



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

General Science: Grade 8



Household Items - General Science: Grade 8



Quick Links

General Science: Grade 8

∞ [AmScope key for slide IDs](#)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



General Science: Grade 8

How To Teach



Introduce

- Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap.
- Often, the introduction in the lesson plans or the title of the book's section can help learners to draw out the main idea. Use this to support learners, as appropriate.
- Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.
- Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.



Read

- Read or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their journal, notebook, or other paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, and beyond.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling events, describing, explaining a concept, etc. Tips about helping learners deal with various types of passages are provided, but teachers can learn more in Charlotte Mason's School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, PowerPoint, etc, to process and convey ideas in their own way.
- Teachers may take turns to model.



Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage, keeping in mind that oftentimes new concepts are not going to be 'mastered' on the first or even second introduction. Mastery is not necessarily the goal, but curiosity and thinking.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans (or even lab books) to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. Alternatively, many of these can be used for composition, depending on the needs of the learner and the instructional goals of the teacher. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.
- Note that learners may need to spend more than the allotted time engaging with or even

repeating a lesson before moving on or as reinforcement at a later time. Adjust the pace as needed to feed the learner.

- Notice if there were any dates that they want to keep for their Book of Centuries.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner needs and interest.
- These can be viewed as alternative ways to engage.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Setting the Stage

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

This book tells the story of how physical science developed from the Renaissance into the 1800s. As you move through the story, notice how ideas and knowledge about the world around us changed through a combination of imagination and experimentation. There are many interesting sidebars and tangents in the text, but read the main text first and then explore them, as desired. Watch the course introduction video:

∞ Video Link: Form 3 Science Intro (5:04)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.1-6 "For centuries" - "good place to start."

- What do you gather so far about the author's purpose for this chapter?

★ TEACHER TIP

Watch the course introduction video with your student(s).

★ TEACHER TIP

As we will begin some notebooking next week, help students notice the author's structure and purpose this week during discussion.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Beginning of the Renaissance (c.1453)

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

Setting the Stage

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.6-13 "Imagine yourself" - "familiar landmarks."

- This chapter sets the scene for Copernicus. Describe that scene.
- Consider the relationship between church and state in Copernicus' time. Was a singular church and state good for either the church or the person? If so, in what ways? In what ways was it bad for both the church and the person? Is a separate church and state bad for either the church or the person? If so, in what ways? In what ways is it good for both?

★ TEACHER NOTE

A simplified contrast between medieval philosophical and theological beliefs and modern scientific beliefs is presented on the p.10 sidebar. Teachers might allow it to pass by the way, engage students in discussion, or skip this one (the larger ongoing picture takes shape over the year).

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

Copernicus

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.14-20 "Copernicus" - "defines the age."

- Tell about Copernicus' life.
- Describe the shift in ideas observed by the author.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Nicolaus Copernicus (1473-1543)

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 4

Copernicus in the Renaissance

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Recall what you read about Copernicus' life and the Renaissance setting for our story. As you continue reading, begin taking notes, jotting down the ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. If you'd like to see a few examples, watch the Notebooking video:

∞ Video Link: Notebooking? (1:39)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.20-31 "Since we have"- "and the earth."

- Describe the contradictions observed in Renaissance society.
- Discuss the scientific and religious ideas on Copernicus' mind.

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. Invite them to share their notebook entries to improve the discussion!

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 5

Leonardo da Vinci

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.32-35 "What's to be" - "and the Arno."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Leonardo da Vinci.

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 6

Copernicus Has a Problem

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 p.36-43 "Copernicus is" - "move the earth."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What does the author mean by "thought experiment"?
- Discuss some of Copernicus' questions.
- Explain Copernicus's conflict over his ideas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Copernicus published On the Revolutions of the Heavenly Spheres (1543).

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 7

Tycho Brahe Observes

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.44-48 "The movement" - "is going on?"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Tycho's early life.
- Explain why Tycho's approach was such an important development in thought.
- Why did people think that "perfect" meant "unchanging"? Discuss the implications of this idea.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Tycho Brahe (1546-1601)

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 8

Tycho Brahe Observes

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.48-57 "Only once" - "sending up sprouts."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about this episode in Tycho's life.
- Compare the models of Ptolemy, Copernicus, and Tycho using words, drawings, or diagrams.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The timescale of traveling light is mentioned on p.51: "It has taken 20,000 years..." Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to consider alternative theories they would like to share.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Newton At the Center
Choose events from the timeline on p.56-57.

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 9

What is Parallax?

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.58-61 "When Tycho" - "a solar system."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain what parallax is and how it is used.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 10

Enter Galileo

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.62-66 "Twenty-one years" - "in scientific circles."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Galileo's family and early life.
- Describe the personality traits the author attributes to Galileo. How are these similar or different from the other scientists you've read about?
- Galileo understood the need for "accurate, repeated experiments." Explain how his observation of the swinging chandelier helps him realize this need.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Galileo (1564-1642)

WEEK 4

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 11

Enter Galileo

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.66-71 "It is in Pisa" - "scientific questioning."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe Galileo's supposed experiment in Pisa.
- How is Galileo's personality getting in his way?
- A recurring theme, the authorities are very concerned about dangerous ideas. What are they afraid of?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The theological beliefs of Bruno are mentioned on p.71 within the context of heresy and politics. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to engage students in discussion.

WEEK 4

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 12

Galileo, the Thinker

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.72-79 "Galileo isn't" - "understand that."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain how scientists, like Galileo, use math to understand relationships.
- What are mathematical relationships? (Mathematical ideas, like geometry and patterns, are important!)
- Tell how Galileo discovered his Law of Freefall.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Hammer Versus Feather on the Moon (1:22)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

WEEK 5

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 13

Thinking about Motion

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.80-83 "Motion. How is" - "because it's important."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain Galileo's thought experiment and his Principle of Relativity.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 14

Thinking about Motion

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.83-89 "What Galileo does" - "at its core."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain how Galileo's Relativity applies to our observations, looking at the sky, a moving vehicle, or a thrown ball.

★ TEACHER TIP

Are your learner(s) demonstrating more familiarity/interest in motion? More interest/ease in discussing the relationship between science and society? If not, consider observing and discussing together more often, exploring extra helpings, or taking a field trip to a play ground, a science museum with an engineering exhibit, or an art museum with kinetic art. Reach out through Contact Us if you need help.

WEEK 5

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 15

Thinking about Stars

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.90-94 "Despite his enemies" - "feel the pull."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Contrast the reaction of most people when they see the supernova or the comet with Galileo's. How is this an echo of Galileo's larger problem with the authorities?
- Describe Galileo's viewpoint on revealed knowledge.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: What is a Comet Made of? (3:31)

∞ Video Link: Night time Lapse of Comet Lovejoy (1:44)

→ NOTE

Read About Suns and Stuff p.95-97 for interest, if desired.

- Describe or diagram the life cycle of a star, including descriptions of each phase.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Galileo distinguishes between answers found through the use of our senses or in the Bible on p.92: "I do not" - "in the Bible." The age of the universe is mentioned throughout p.95-97. Teachers might choose to allow these to pass by the way, to discuss with students, or to consider alternative theories they would like to share. The optional reading could be skipped if preferred.

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 16

Galileo Challenges the World

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.98-105 "Galileo is" - "the heavens go."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What happens when Galileo gets a telescope?
- How does Galileo's personality contribute to his conflict with authority?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Survive a Trip to the Sun (3:20)

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. You can also invite them to share their notebook entries.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Invention of the telescope (1609)

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 17

The Telescope

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.106-109 "Leonard Digges" - "in the shadows."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Who invented the telescope?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The scale of the universe in millions of light-years is mentioned on p.108. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to consider alternative theories they would like to share.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 18

Galileo in Trouble

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.10 p.110-115 "Galileo doesn't!" - "of his time."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.116-117 "Religion is" - "search a bit."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- We see religious leaders both angry with and engaging with Galileo. Why were they ultimately upset with Galileo? How could the situation have been handled differently?
- Explain religion and science using a metaphor of 2 parallel lines of thinking in the mind.
- Is the title of the passage on p.116-117 the best title for the ideas presented? If so, explain. If not, what would you title it?

★ TEACHER TIP

When passages have different main topics, some students will be able to read them through and organize the content in their minds. For other students, it can be helpful to read and narrate the passages separately, even if they are doing the work consecutively in the same lesson period. This helps the mind work through the ideas in smaller chunks.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The balance between doctrine and politics is considered on p.113, 116-117. Teachers are encouraged to preread these sidebars for better discussion.

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 19

Kepler's Theories on Planetary Motion

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.118-124 "Do you think" - "published in 1611."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Kepler.
- Describe Kepler's interest in optics and how this leads to a connection with Galileo.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Johannes Kepler (1571-1630)

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 20

Kepler's Theories on Planetary Motion

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.11 p.124-128 "Meanwhile" - "do just that"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.129-131 "An ellipse" - "Earth and Sun."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain Kepler's belief that his work as a scientist is God's intent for him, his vocation.
- Contrast Kepler's thoughts on creation with those of previous scientists.
- How does Kepler's work generate new questions?
- What is an ellipse? What is eccentricity?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The timescale of change in Earth's orbital path is mentioned on p.131: "in a 100,000-year cycle." Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to consider alternative theories they would like to share.

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 21

Descartes and His Coordinates

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 p.132-136 "Galileo is 32" - "those coordinates."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or

• IMPORTANT DATES

René Descartes (1596-1650)

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain how the Cartesian coordinate system works.

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 22

Descartes and His Coordinates

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.12 p.136-139 "Like him or not" - "home to rest."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 p.141-143 "On June 21" - "hundreds of years."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain how even wrong ideas, such as Descartes' vortices, can be helpful in science.
- Tell the story of Fermat's Last Theorem.

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 23

Meet Isaac Newton

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.144-147 "It turns out" - "ever happening."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Newton's early life.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Isaac Newton (1642-1727)

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 24

Newton Ponders Motion and Math

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.147-153 "When he is 16" - "he is doing."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe Newton's personality traits. How does he relate to others? What kinds of things does he think about?
- Tell the story of how Newton learns math and invents calculus.
- Explain the links in the chain that led to Newton's ideas on universal gravity.

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 25

Newton Puzzles Over Gravity

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14 p.154-159 "The celebrated" - "that it doesn't."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Why is this chapter so titled?

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 26

What is Calculus?

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14 p.160-163 "With arithmetic" - "at any point."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain what calculus is and what it can be used for.

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 27

Thinking about Light

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.164-171 "Newton keeps" - "that new world."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss Newton's work related to light.
- Discuss Newton and Hooke's disagreement and their relationship.
- Discuss Newton's concerns about religion.

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 28

Newton's Laws of Motion

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.172-177 "Is motion" - "in his head."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain Newton's Laws of Motion.
- Discuss the implications of these laws in relation to astronomy.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 29

Fame Finds Newton

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.178-183 "Newton has" - "himself a star."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss Newton and Halley's relationship. What impact does it have on Newton?
- Why was the Principia important?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Newton publishes Principia (1687)

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 30

Fame Finds Newton

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.184-187 "The French had" - "last by science."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Halley's Comet (1758)
Appeared last (1986)
Next appearance (2061)

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Describe the appearance of Halley's Comet from the perspective of someone in 1758. What do you imagine they were thinking?	
WEEK 11 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 31 <i>Measuring Light</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.18 p.188-195 "Can the speed" - "at the sky." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. - Tell the story of Roemer and Jupiter's moons. - Consider the significance of Roemer's realization.	• IMPORTANT DATES Olaus Christensen Roemer (1644-1710) Christiaan Huygens (1629-1695)
WEEK 11 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 32 <i>Measuring Light</i> Materials: Newton at the Center PREP: Read Teacher Tip → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.18 p.196-197 "Of the four" - "more impressive." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. Study the diagram on p.197. Why would Jupiter's light be brighter sometimes than at other times? If one year equals one trip around the sun, how old would you be if you lived on Jupiter?	★ TEACHER TIP When student(s) take exams next week, evaluate what they recall, but more importantly whether motion or the relationship between science and society are more familiar or have possibly even become a particular friend! If no relational growth is observed, consider why: do they need more hands-on time, more reading support, less business, etc? Reach out through Contact Us if you need help.
WEEK 11 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 33 <i>Catch Up</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 34 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Newton at the Center	
WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 35 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Newton at the Center	
WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Newton at the Center	

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 37

Thinking about Matter

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19 p.198-203 "Aristotle thought" - "close to finding it."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Set the stage for alchemy.

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. You can also invite them to share their notebook entries.

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 38

Thinking about Matter

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.19 p.203-207 "Bernard of Treves" - "resounding 'Yes.'"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19 p.208-209 "Hennig Brandt" - "specific discoverer."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about the demise of alchemy.
- Tell about the discovery of phosphorus.

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 39

Measuring Matter

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20 p.210-215 "Irish-born Robert" - "corpuscles seriously."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Robert Boyle.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Robert Boyle (1627-1691)

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 40

Is Air Something - or Nothing?

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20 p.216-219 "Air seems" - "popular entertainment."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Is air something or nothing?

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 41

Thinking about Energy and Matter

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21 p.220-225 "Daniel Bernoulli" - "ahead of the times."

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about the Bernoulli brothers.

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 42

Thinking about Energy and Matter

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21 p.225-229 "Now, let's skip" - "to technology."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain or diagram what you understand about Daniel Bernoulli's principle.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Daniel Bernoulli (1700-1782)

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 43

"Nature is squaring itself."

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22 p.230-237 "Think gorgeous" - "built on it."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell why Émilie du Châtelet didn't fit in.
- Explain the mistake that Émilie discovered.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The affair between Émilie du Châtelet and Voltaire is introduced on p.232. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Emilie du Châtelet (1706-1749)
Voltaire (1694-1778)

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 44

Many Gases

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23 p.238-245 "Just what is" - "have them?"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Chemistry is just getting started, but it is very disorganized. Discuss.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The age of some rock is mentioned in a caption on p.239, "roughly 65 million years or so ago." Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to consider alternative theories they would like to share.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Joseph Priestley (1733-1804)
Benjamin Franklin (1706-1790)

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 45

The Thermometer

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23 p.246-249 "Daniel Fahrenheit" - "the temperature."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Daniel Fahrenheit.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Daniel Fahrenheit (1686-1736)

WEEK 4

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 46

Weighing the World

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24 p.250-259 "Henry Cavendish" - "Earth's density."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Big Bang is mentioned toward the end of p.258. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to consider alternative theories they would like to share.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Henry Cavendish (1731-1810)

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

	connections you make along the way, too.	
	Explain how Cavendish measured the density of the world using words, drawings, or diagrams.	
WEEK 4	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 47 <i>Chemistry is Finally Here!</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.25 p.260-265 "It is the" - "revolution in science." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. Discuss what the "big idea" is in this chapter. What is Lavoisier doing?	• IMPORTANT DATES Antoine-Laurent Lavoisier (1743-1794)
WEEK 4	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 48 <i>Lavoisier Establishes Chemistry</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.26 p.266-274 "His parents" - "ideas survive." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. - Why is Lavoisier called the "Father of Chemistry"? - What is an element? - What do we mean by "conservation of mass"? - Why is hypothesizing an important part of the scientific method? → NOTE Read France Sings a Metric Tune p.275-277 for interest, if desired.	
WEEK 5	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 49 <i>Elements and Atoms</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.27 p.278-287 "Way back" - "explain their world." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. - Discuss how Dalton builds on the ideas of Lavoisier. - Create a graphic or diagram of Dalton's ideas about elements and atoms.	• NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link. • IMPORTANT DATES John Dalton (1766-1844)
WEEK 5	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 50 <i>Atoms and Molecules</i> Materials: Newton at the Center PREP: Read Teacher Tip → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ & NARRATE Ch.28 p.288-293 "Amedeo Avogadro" - "complicated things." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.28 p.294-297 "So what makes" - "New Dimension." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. - Explain atoms versus molecules. - Explain Avogadro's Law.	★ TEACHER TIP Are your learner(s) demonstrating more familiarity/interest in chemistry or matter? More interest/ease in discussing the relationship between science and society? If not, consider observing and discussing together more often, exploring extra helpings, or taking a field trip to a science museum with a chemistry exhibit. Reach out through Contact Us if you need help. • IMPORTANT DATES Amedeo Avogadro (1776-1856)

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

• Discuss how difficult it can be to believe something you cannot see. Consider how people of science and religion both experience this. • Tell how and what Edward Frankland discovered about chemical bonding.	
WEEK 5 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 51 <i>Making Sense of Matter</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.29 p.298-308 "Scientists don't" - "that's exciting." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell about Mendeleyev's life. • Tell about Mendeleyev's work.	• IMPORTANT DATES Dmitri Mendeleyev (1834-1907) Periodic Table of Elements (1869)
WEEK 6 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 52 <i>The Periodic Table</i> Materials: Newton at the Center PREP: Read Teacher Tip → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.29 p.309-311 "So far" - "New Dimension." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell what you know about the Periodic Table.	★ TEACHER TIP Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. You can also invite them to share their notebook entries. • IMPORTANT DATES The four newest elements added to the Periodic Table (2019)
WEEK 6 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 53 <i>Thinking about Heat</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.30 p.312-321 "Fill a teacup" - "two philosophers!" Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell about Benjamin Thompson's life. • Explain Thompson's ideas about heat.	• IMPORTANT DATES Benjamin Thompson (1753-1814)
WEEK 6 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 54 <i>Studying Electricity</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.31 p.322-327 "You may remember" - "Newton's ideas." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell a story about the Leyden jar. • How does Benjamin Franklin "link action in the heavens to that on Earth"?	• IMPORTANT DATES Benjamin Franklin (1706-1790)
WEEK 7 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 55 <i>Studying Electricity</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS	• NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link. • IMPORTANT DATES Alessandro Volta (1745-1827)

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Ch.31 p.327-333 "Franklin isn't" - "path of science." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Discuss how Volta harnesses electricity. • Explain what is learned about elements and magnetism through this harnessed electricity.	
WEEK 7 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 56 <i>A Pendulum's Proof</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.31 p.334-337 "Way back" - "Amir D. Aczel." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Describe Foucault's pendulum experiment. → SUPPLEMENTAL ∞ Video Link: Foucault's Pendulum Explained (3:20) ∞ Video Link: Foucault Pendulum Time Lapse (watch to 4:45)	• IMPORTANT DATES Jean-Bernard-Leon Foucault (1819-1868) Foucault's Pendulum Experiment (1851)
WEEK 7 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 57 <i>Faraday Experiments</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.32 p.338-345 "It is January" - "he isn't finished." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain Faraday's concept of "fields." • Tell about Faraday's efforts to improve communication in science. Why is communication so important? • Discuss Faraday's habit of finding an opportunity to learn in every situation, that is, learning for the sake of learning. • Explain Faraday's hypothesis and experiment about electricity and magnetism.	• IMPORTANT DATES Michael Faraday (1791-1867)
WEEK 8 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 58 <i>Relating Electricity and Magnetism</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.32 p.345-351 "Faraday is" - "Victoria." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • How was imagination important to Faraday's work? • Explain how Faraday imagined light in his fields.	• NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.
WEEK 8 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 59 <i>Thinking about Light</i> Materials: Newton at the Center → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.32 p.352-355 "The Bible says" - "an understatement." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Is light a particle or a wave?	

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 60

Maxwell's Equations

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 p.356-365 "James Clerk Maxwell"- "of all time."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Maxwell's life.
- Explain what Maxwell does with Faraday's ideas on light. How do the two scientists complement each other?
- "Today, James Clerk Maxwell is ranked with the greatest scientists of all time." Tell why this is, using any combination of pictures and/or words.

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Clerk Maxwell (1831-1879)

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 61

What is Frequency?

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 p.366-369 "My kids tell"- "than light."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain frequency, using any combination of pictures and/or words.

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 62

What is Heat?

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.34 p.370-373, 377-379 "Ludwig Eduard"- "related suicide."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell about Boltzmann's life.
- Describe how Boltzmann built upon Maxwell's ideas.
- Explain the frustrating debate about atoms.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The suicide of Boltzmann is mentioned in the last sentence on p.379. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Ludwig Boltzmann (1844-1906)

WEEK 9

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 63

Invisible Ideas

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.34 p.374-376 "Gas molecules" - "and direction."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.34 p.380-383 "In this book" - "managed it."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain the relationship between kinetic energy and temperature.
- Summarize what you know about atoms.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 64

Putting Energy to Work

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.35 p.384-389 "This is a" - "to human effort."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What is work?
- Explain or draw a series of diagrams that show the potential and kinetic energy of a ball being thrown up into the air.

→ NOTE

Read Information-Age Thinking in the Industrial Era p.390-393 for interest, if desired.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Joule (1818-1889)

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 65

First Law of Thermodynamics

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.36 p.394-399 "We have now" - "discoveries of physics."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain "conservation of energy."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Julius von Mayer (1814-1878)

Ferdinand von Helmholtz (1821-1894)

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 66

Second Law of Thermodynamics

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37 p.400-405 "The first law" - "be used again."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Entropy can be tricky to understand. Explain it in terms of "energy spread."

WEEK 11

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 67

Second Law of Thermodynamics

Materials: Newton at the Center

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37 p.405-411 "Now if I've" - "a meaningful answer."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain entropy in terms of probability.
- Is there a difference between understanding entropy in terms of energy spread or probability?

★ TEACHER TIP

When student(s) take exams next week, evaluate what they recall, but more importantly whether chemistry, matter, electricity, magnetism, or the relationship between science and society are more familiar or have possibly even become a particular friend! If no relational growth is observed, consider why: do they need more hands-on time, more reading support, less business, etc? Reach out through Contact Us if you need help.

WEEK 11

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 68

Things We Don't Understand

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.38 p.412-415 "If you want" - "a Nobel Prize."

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What does imagination have to do with science?

WEEK 11 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 69

Pursuit of Scientific Truth

Materials: Newton at the Center

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.39-40 p.416-431 "Albert Michelson" - "of all time."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- How would you answer someone today who argues that everything there is to know about a scientific field has already been discovered?
- What is more important in science: theory or experimentation?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Antoine-Henri Becquerel (1852-1908)

First X-Rays (1895)

WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 70

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Newton at the Center

WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Newton at the Center

WEEK 12 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Newton at the Center

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 73

Introducing Einstein and Recapping

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

This book continues the story of science from Newton at the Center. We will learn how the ideas and culture of science developed in surprising directions in the modern era, even as the process of science remained the same. These concepts are challenging to grasp and are meant to stretch the mind and engage the imagination. It is not essential that every technical concept be fully understood. Let the lab book guide you on which concepts to focus on. Break the assigned reading into chunks, as needed. Reading and narrating smaller chunks can be helpful even when reading in one sitting. Allowing the reading to spill over into free reading time is also okay. Learning what works for you is an important skill that will help in high school.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.1-17 "Fifteen-year-old" - "ever seeing one?"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss why Albert Einstein had such a hard time in school.
- Consider what it would be like if you could travel on a beam of light.
- Recall some of the historical events in science that have taken place so far. Recall some of the "big ideas" we've encountered.

★ TEACHER TIP

Passages are not presented in parts this term. Observe how students manage them and encourage them to read and narrate the ideas in chunks, as needed.

★ TEACHER NOTE

A review of religious and political conflict is covered on p.10-12. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Albert Einstein (1879-1955)
Industrial Revolution (1760-1840)
Euclid (4th B.C.)

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 74

Electricity, Magnetism, and Light

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.18-35 "Science has" - "method employed."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Science is the search for connections and patterns. Discuss this statement.
- Describe Michelson and Morley's experiment.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Samuel Morse (1791-1872) sent an electric current from Washington D.C. to Baltimore (1844).
Thomas Edison (1847-1931)
Nikola Tesla (1856-1943)
Any dates from the timeline on p.20-21

WEEK 1

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 75

Thinking about Electrons

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.36-49 "Joseph John Thomson" - "skilled experimenter."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe the debate surrounding electricity.

• IMPORTANT DATES

J.J. Thomson (1856-1940) presents his corpuscles of electricity to the Royal Institution (1897).
Max Planck (1858-1947)
Robert Millikan (1869-1953)

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 76

What are Atoms Anyway?

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.50-57 "J.J. has two" - "the uranium."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What do scientists think about atoms at this time?
- Tell what you know about Marie Curie's work.

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. You can also invite them to share their notebook entries.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Marie Curie (1867-1934)
Any dates from the timeline on p.57

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 77

Investigating Atoms

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.58-69 "J.J. Thomson's" - "inside the atom."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain how work with radioactivity reveals an understanding of atoms.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Marie and Pierre Curie discovered polonium (1898).

Marie Curie isolated radium (1902).

Chernobyl Nuclear Power Plant explosion (1986)

WEEK 2

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 78

Theorizing

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.70-85 "Max Karl Ernst" - "is turned down."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- If Planck didn't believe his equation, why did he develop it? Why did he even think about it if he wasn't sure it was real?
- Discuss what Einstein did with all of the seemingly contradictory information.

★ TEACHER NOTE

A daughter born to Albert Einstein and Mileva Maric before their marriage is mentioned on p.80. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Planck's constant quantizes energy (1900)

Einstein published his 5 famous papers (1905).

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 79

Light as Wave and Particle

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.86-97 "For 10 years" - "to the explanation."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Light is both a wave and a particle. Discuss.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Lord Rayleigh (1842-1919) explains why the sky is blue (1871).

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 80

Modeling the Unseen

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13 p.98-113 "It is 1827" - "to find out."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe how the role of mathematics in science is developing.
- Describe Rutherford's gold foil experiment.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Ernest Rutherford (1871-1937) conducted his gold foil experiment, revealing the nucleus of the atom (1909).

WEEK 3

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 81

Getting Atoms

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14 p.114-127 "Rutherford and" - "astrophysics soared."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The birth of the universe is mentioned in the sidebar on p.125. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way, to discuss with students, or to consider alternative theories they want to share.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Niels Bohr (1885-1962) introduced his model of the atom (1913).

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

	• Explain how the concept of the atom changed from Thomson to Rutherford to Bohr. • Explain Bohr and Einstein's difference of opinion. How can they be such good friends when they disagree so fundamentally?	
WEEK 4	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 82 <i>Still Shooting Alpha Particles</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.15 p.128-135 "In 1916" - "still ahead." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain what nuclear chemistry continues to reveal about the atom.	★ TEACHER NOTE Carbon-14 dating is introduced in the sidebar on p.135. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way, to discuss with students, or to consider alternative theories they want to share. • IMPORTANT DATES Francis Aston (1877-1945) invented a mass spectrograph to identify the isotopes of various elements (1919). Any dates from the timeline on p.130
WEEK 4	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 83 <i>Matter as Particle and Wave</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.16-17 p.136-149 "Niels Bohr" - "of your view." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • What is quantum mechanics? • Discuss Bohr and Einstein's friendship. Was it so great because of or despite their difference of opinion? Why? • Discuss the development of the wave-particle idea.	★ TEACHER NOTE The end of Ch.16 is missing from the Kindle edition. It should include: "United States, as they will soon learn." • IMPORTANT DATES Arthur Compton (1892-1962) demonstrated the particle nature of light (1923). Louis-Victor de Broglie (1892-1987) showed mathematically that matter has wave properties (1924). G.P. Thomson (1892-1975) demonstrated the wave nature of electrons (1927).
WEEK 4	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 84 <i>Uncertainty Principle</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.18 p.150-157 "The more Niels" - "mentor and poet." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Why is the chapter titled so? • What statistics are necessary? Why does Einstein dislike this?	★ TEACHER NOTE The end of Ch.18 is missing from the Kindle edition. It should include: "practical formulas that lead to technological marvels. The founders of quantum mechanics became heroes in an atomic and technological age. Niels Bohr is their mentor and poet." • IMPORTANT DATES Werner Heisenberg (1901-1976) introduced the Uncertainty Principle (1925).
WEEK 5	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 85 <i>Quantum Mechanics</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.19-20 p.158-172 "Erwin Schrödinger" - "goes to war." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain the idea of Schrödinger's cat and what he meant to explain by it. • How did Dirac fuse wave mechanics and particle mechanics? • Tell what you know about atoms so far.	• IMPORTANT DATES Erwin Schrödinger (1887-1961) formulated his wave equation to describe electrons (1926). Schrödinger describes duality as his famous cat (1935). Paul Dirac (1902-1984), John Cockcroft, and Ernest Walton completed their linear particle accelerator (1932).
WEEK 5	30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 86 <i>Physics and Chemistry</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time.	• IMPORTANT DATES Linus Pauling (1901-1994), Francis Crick, and James Watson discovered the chemical structure of DNA (1953). Any dates from the timeline on p.185

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-21 p.172-189 "After the war" - "one way or another."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain why scientists want to accelerate particles and how Einstein's equation is proven.
- Who was Linus Pauling?

WEEK 5

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 87

Energy and Mass

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-23 p.190-203 "Scientific thoughts" - "World War II begins."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain the implications of Einstein's equation.
- Discuss the collision of science with World War II. This is a discussion that should continue for many lessons!

★ TEACHER NOTE

Legal cases regarding evolution in the classroom and victimized/marginalized groups are mentioned on p.194, 198, respectively. Teachers might choose to allow these to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Any events noted in Ch.23 (the chapter serves as an expanded timeline)

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 88

The Race to Fission

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24 p.204-219 "It is September" - "nuclear energy."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain what you know about how nuclear fission of the uranium nucleus occurs.

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to engage students in their reading through natural discussion. If you need help, use the bulleted prompts. You can also invite them to share their notebook entries.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Irène and Frédéric Joliot-Curie created the first radioactive isotope artificially (1933). Enrico Fermi split the uranium nucleus (1934). Lise Meitner and Otto Frisch discovered that nuclear fission had occurred in the Hahn lab (1938).

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 89

The Bomb

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.25 p.220-235 "In 1938" - "else possible."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe the scientific race that is beginning.

★ TEACHER TIP

Are your learner(s) demonstrating more familiarity/interest in energy or light? More interest/ease in discussing the process of science or the role that curiosity and uncertainty play? If not, consider observing and discussing together more often, exploring extra helpings, or taking a field trip to a planetarium. Reach out through Contact Us if you need help.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Einstein wrote his letter to FDR (1939). Glenn Seaborg discovered plutonium (1940). Self-sustaining nuclear chain reaction (1942)

WEEK 6

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 90

The Manhattan Project

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26 p.236-253 "In 1943" - "lost its innocence."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Tell the story of the Manhattan Project from the perspective of the scientists.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The end of Ch.26 is missing from the Kindle edition. It should include: "on making the world better, well, science had lost its innocence."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Hiroshima and Nagasaki were bombed (1945).

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 91

Quantum Electrodynamics

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.27-28 p.254-165 "The theoretical" - "they never have."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- How does science proceed after the war?
- Recall Galileo's relativity and explain Einstein's ideas.
- What is the big idea about QED? How does it relate to previous ideas? How does it improve our model of the universe?

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 92

Relativity

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.29 p.266-275 "When Isaac" - "you inhabit."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Explain spacetime.
- Why were previous models of the universe wrong? What key idea was necessary?
- How can stretching the mind and engaging the imagination be helpful in our pursuit of "I AM"?

WEEK 7

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 93

Spacetime

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-31 p.276-289 "Einstein asks" - "he be thinking?"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss how different realities can exist for different observers, according to relativity.
- Discuss time from our perspective versus time from the perspective of a beam of light.
- Consider that Einstein's thought was steeped in Jewish theology. Discuss any spiritual implications that come to mind.

★ TEACHER TIP

Don't worry if the ideas in the text don't quite make sense - they are challenging! These are lifetime ideas for most of us. Engaging with them to see the big picture is what's important.

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 94

Speed of Light

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32-33 p.290-301 "Albert Einstein" - "under your hat."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Continue discussing Einstein's challenging idea!

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 8

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 95

Relative Gravity

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.34 p.302-311 "Gravity. The very" - "with a red flower." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain Einstein's thought experiment regarding gravity. • What does gravity have to do with relativity?	
WEEK 8 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 96 <i>Spacetime and the Universe</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.35-36 p.312-325 "By 1915" - "surprises are coming." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain gravity in terms of spacetime. • Explain how a solar eclipse proved Einstein's idea. • Einstein was not perfect. Discuss his acceptance of this fact based on what you have read. → SUPPLEMENTAL ∞ Video Link: General Relativity Demo (3:20)	★ TEACHER NOTE The end of Einstein's first marriage and his relationship with his second wife are introduced on p.317. Ideas concerning the temporal and spatial finiteness of the universe are discussed on p.322-325. Teachers might choose to allow these to pass by the way or to discuss with students. • IMPORTANT DATES General relativity was confirmed during the solar eclipse (1919).
WEEK 9 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 97 <i>An Expanding Universe</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.37-38 p.326-339 "In 1917" - "thinks it is." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Explain what is meant by red-shifted light. • Explain why scientists hypothesized that the universe is expanding. • Discuss Lemaître's ideas.	★ TEACHER NOTE Ideas concerning the expansion of the universe and the introduction of the Big Bang theory are discussed on p.326-339. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way, to discuss with students, or to consider alternative theories they would like to share. • NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link. • IMPORTANT DATES Edwin Hubble (1889-1953) discovered other galaxies (1925) and observed the expansion of the universe (1929).
WEEK 9 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 98 <i>The Fates of Stars</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.39-40 p.340-355 "His real name" - "is at war." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell about Chandra. • Tell what you know about stars.	• IMPORTANT DATES Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar (1910-1995) discovered that certain stars do not become white dwarfs. Any dates from the timeline on p.352
WEEK 9 30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 99 <i>Black Holes</i> Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension → RECAP Briefly recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.41 p.356-369 "When supermassive" - "gets his magazine." Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too. • Tell what you know about black holes.	★ TEACHER NOTE The Big Bang is considered in the quote on p.359; a bet with a payoff of a "subscription to a racy magazine" is mentioned on p.365; the age of the Earth and the Big Bang are mentioned in the sidebar on p.368. Teachers might choose to allow these to pass by the way or to discuss with students. • IMPORTANT DATES Astronauts Armstrong, Aldrin, and Collins landed on the moon (1969).

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 100

Gravity Waves?

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.42 p.370-381 "Deep in a pine" - "Stay tuned."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Describe the 4 interactions between matter: strong, electromagnetism, weak, and gravity.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Big Bang and the age of the universe are further considered on p.372-373, 377. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 101

More Unseen in Space and Time

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.43 p.382-391 "It is 1948" - "with such precision."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What do particles and waves have to do with the "big bang"?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Big Bang and the age of the universe are further considered on p.382-391. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

WEEK 10

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 102

Inflation and the Theory of Everything

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.44 p.392-405 "A tiny acorn" - "cosmological system."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- What is "inflation" to an astrophysicist?

→ NOTE

Read Ch.45 p.406-413 for interest, if desired.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Big Bang and the age of the universe are further considered on p.392-405 and in the optional reading on p.408. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

WEEK 11

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 103

Difficult Predictions

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.46 p.414-427 "Brian Schmidt" - "be the limit."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss the problem with the theory of expansion.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Big Bang and the age of the universe are further considered on p.415-425. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 11

30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 104

Difficult Predictions

Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.47 p.428-437 "Clocks were" - "it's so long!"

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or

★ TEACHER TIP

When student(s) take exams next week, evaluate what they recall, but more importantly whether energy, light, the process of science, or the habits we need to practice as scientists are more familiar or have possibly even become a particular friend! If no relational growth is observed, consider why: do they need more hands-on time, more reading support, less business, etc? Reach out through Contact Us if you need help or have any concerns about readiness for the next stage in relationship building.

General Science: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

connections you make along the way, too.

- Discuss how we use metaphors to help us think about ideas.

WEEK 11 **30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 105**

Difficult Predictions

 Materials: Einstein Adds a New Dimension

→ RECAP

Briefly recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.48-49 p.438-454 "Do you believe" - "yet to discover."

Note ideas that stand out to you in words, pictures, or diagrams. Record any questions or connections you make along the way, too.

- "The classical scientists believed that understanding nature would bring the power of exact prediction." Discuss.
- Discuss why science is about what we don't know rather than what we do.
- Why is the everyday still complex and difficult to predict, despite all that science has learned?
- Consider Einstein's question printed on p.449: "Did God have any choice in the creation of the world?" If the universe has to be the way that it is for "deep mathematical reasons," does that prohibit God's choice and creativity? Or does that rather tell us something about God?
- Do some research to find out how ideas have changed or developed around this question of life on other planets.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The age of the universe is mentioned on p.448. Teachers might choose to allow this to pass by the way or to discuss with students.

WEEK 12 **30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 106**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Einstein Adds a New Dimension

WEEK 12 **30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 107**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Einstein Adds a New Dimension

WEEK 12 **30m General Science: Grade 8 - Lesson 108**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Einstein Adds a New Dimension

General Science: Grade 8

Examination

Term 1

- Newton at the Center: Explain how the study of motion helped scientists, like Brahe, Galileo, and Kepler, learn new things about planetary movement.
- Newton at the Center: Explain both perspectives of the conflict between Galileo and the Church.
- Newton at the Center: Explain Newton's 3 Laws of motion using words, drawings, and/or diagrams.
- Explain how you did one laboratory investigation this term and what you learned from it.

Term 2

- Newton at the Center: Newton, Boyle, Cavendish, Lavoisier, and many others made important discoveries about matter. Explain how their work helped transition alchemy into a true science, called chemistry.
- Newton at the Center: Explain 3 ways that moving particles can affect other matter.
- Newton at the Center: Discuss the relationship between electricity and magnetism.
- Explain how you did one laboratory investigation this term and what you learned from it.

Term 3

- Einstein Adds a New Dimension: Tell what you know about the nature of light.
- Einstein Adds a New Dimension: Explain what is meant by $E = mc^2$ and give examples as to how this is relevant in the world.
- Einstein Adds a New Dimension: Describe the process of science, using examples from the text, as needed.
- Explain how you did one laboratory investigation this term and what you learned from it.